



Community and Economic
Development

Future of Large-Scale Performing Arts – Resolution

Portland City Council City Life Committee
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Steering Committee

After reviewing and discussing related information over seven months, the Steering Committee of technical experts voted on a recommended path forward in June 2026.

Recommendations:

- Build a new Broadway-capable venue as part of the proposed Performing Arts + Culture Center at Portland State University (PSU)
- Simultaneously, create an actionable plan to reimagine the Keller Auditorium and/or site based on Portland's historic, cultural, and civic values in accordance with passionate public support expressed by the community.



Ex Officio Table Recommendations

After reviewing and discussing related information over five months, a majority of the Ex Officio table recommended a path forward for this work in June 2026.

Recommendations:

- Advance the PSU performing arts center
- Form a Technical Advisory Committee to support pre-development financial functions
- While PSU development is ongoing, maintain Broadway shows at the Keller
- At the same time, initiate planning for the Keller's future—including financial analysis, market feasibility, and design—to allow for construction to begin once the PSU venue opens
- When the PSU venue becomes operational, transition Broadway productions there, and begin renovation of the Keller into a modern 1,200–1,800 seat venue tailored to Portland's mid-size market needs



Overview of Proposed Resolution

Accept the Future of Large-Scale Performing Arts recommendations to:

- Advance a new Broadway-capable venue as part of the proposed Performing Arts + Culture Center at PSU
- Initiate planning for the future of the Keller Auditorium

Capitalize on the state's funding commitment of \$137.5 million, public private partnerships, and a future forward vision that expands Portland's arts ecosystem



Proposed Resolution: Next Steps for PSU venue

Affirms the City's commitment to a new City-owned ~3,000-seat Broadway capable venue as part of the proposed Performing Arts + Culture Center at PSU with goal of opening in 2030

Directs Deputy City Administrator to:

- Stand up a staff project team of technical experts with PSU to complete pre-development work
 - Develop a detailed financial plan with a fully defined capital stack, funding timelines, and return on invested capital that provides a clear understanding of the City's obligations and costs for the project
 - Direct a cohesive, comprehensive philanthropic strategy, collaborate with the PSU Foundation in its role as lead philanthropic strategist, and work together to identify and secure necessary funding
 - Provide input into the initial phases of the project and project construction management direction
- Develop a Project Commitment Agreement with PSU by Dec 1, 2026, that establishes the scope, schedule, and governance framework for the project and a shared commitment between the City and PSU to develop and implement the full capital funding strategy
- Designate a pre-development steering committee to participate in the process as needed



Proposed Resolution: Next Steps for Keller

- Programming, including Broadway shows, will continue while development of a new Broadway-capable venue at PSU is ongoing, to avoid economic losses and to continue cultural activity
- Directs the DCA to direct staff to initiate planning for the future of the Keller Auditorium
 - Conducting community engagement, market study, financial analysis, and initial design work
 - Determine feasibility as a renovated 1,200 to 1,800-seat performing arts venue



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